INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Professional Development

BUSINESS FINANCE SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Accurate – Demonstrate appropriate finance acumen.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Discuss the financial planning process.
2. Discuss employment opportunities in the finance industry.
3. Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker.
4. Utilize resources that can contribute to professional development.
5. Identify skills needed to enhance career progression.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a Certified Financial Planner (CFP) in the wealth management office of NORTHGATE BANK. A bank teller (judge) wants your advice on becoming a financial planner.

The teller (judge) has worked at NORTHGATE for two years and earns $39,000 a year. The teller (judge) enjoys helping customers with their money questions and wants to become a financial planner. The teller (judge) has gathered the following information:

Associate financial planner salary at NORTHGATE	$58,000
CFP education program cost	$6,000
CFP exam fee	$1,000
NORTHGATE tuition reimbursement	75% of education program costs (does not cover exam fee)
Work experience required for CFP	6,000 hours

The teller (judge) doesn't fully understand what financial planners do with clients each day.

The teller (judge) wants you to:

- Explain the steps of the financial planning process.
- Explain employment opportunities for financial planners and related careers in finance.
- Calculate the teller's (judge's) out-of-pocket cost to become a CFP and the first-year pay increase from becoming an associate planner.
- Explain why ongoing education is needed in financial planning.
- Recommend resources and skills that would help the teller (judge) reach this goal.

You will present the information to the teller (judge) in a meeting at the bank. The teller (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking for advice. After you have presented the information and answered the teller's (judge's) questions, the teller (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your help.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Can I start helping clients with financial plans before I'm certified?
2. Once I'm a CFP, why would I still need to keep taking classes?

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Discuss the financial planning process.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Discuss employment opportunities in the finance industry.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Utilize resources that can contribute to professional development.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Identify skills needed to enhance career progression.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Accurate** Demonstrate appropriate finance acumen.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	

Answer key:

- Out of pocket: $1,500 (25% of $6,000) + $1,000 exam = $2,500.
- Pay increase: $58,000 − $39,000 = $19,000 in the first year.